How does Ayushman Bharat help people get healthcare without facing heavy financial burdens?

GS II

KNOWLEDGE POINTS

- **Protection From Hospital Bills:** AB-PMJAY helps eligible families pay for major hospital treatment. Its cashless cover reduces the risk that serious illness will consume savings or push households into debt.
- **Care Near Home:** Ayushman Arogya Mandirs bring primary healthcare closer to communities. People can seek everyday care locally instead of depending only on large hospitals for health services.
- **Stronger Public Facilities:** PM-ABHIM supports hospitals, critical care and disease monitoring. Better health infrastructure strengthens the system that people depend on when serious illness or public health threats arise.
- **Connected Health Records:** The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission helps patients securely share health records with their consent. Doctors at different facilities can access relevant information and provide more coordinated care.
- **Care Across State Borders:** AB-PMJAY allows eligible patients to receive cashless treatment at participating hospitals outside their home State. This helps migrant families and people seeking specialised care elsewhere.

QUICK FACTS

- AB-PMJAY provides Rs 5 lakh per eligible family annually for secondary and tertiary hospitalisation. Unlike care centres, it covers hospital treatment; over 13 crore admissions were authorised.
- Over 1.8 lakh Ayushman Arogya Mandirs offer nearby primary care. PM-ABHIM, launched in 2021 with Rs 64,180 crore, strengthens critical care and disease surveillance infrastructure.
- The National Health Authority sets standards and IT platforms, while State Health Agencies manage hospital empanelment and claims. ABHA enables consent-based health record sharing.
- Ayushman Vay Vandana covers people aged 70 and above regardless of income. Insurance coverage rose from 15% to over 50%; 97 crore ABHA numbers were reported.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Ayushman Bharat links hospital insurance, nearby primary care, stronger public facilities and digital health records, while cross-State treatment access helps reduce financial hardship and improve healthcare access.

How can India grow its economy while protecting the environment and using resources wisely?

GS III

KNOWLEDGE POINTS

- **Cleaner Energy Sources:** Solar and other renewable power can support growing energy needs while reducing dependence on more polluting sources. The article links this shift with new investment and manufacturing opportunities.
- **Using Less Energy:** Efficient lights, buildings and industries deliver useful services with less energy. This lowers waste and emissions while allowing homes and businesses to use resources more productively.
- **Cleaner Industrial Production:** Green hydrogen can help industries such as steel and fertilisers reduce emissions. Building this sector can also create work in equipment, renewable power, storage and transport.
- **Saving Water And Materials:** Water reuse, efficient irrigation and recycling reduce pressure on limited resources. A circular economy keeps materials useful longer instead of treating them only as waste.
- **Resilient Cities And Communities:** Better public transport, green buildings and urban wetlands can improve city life. Planning for floods, heat and water shortages also helps protect development from climate risks.

QUICK FACTS

- The National Solar Mission began in 2010 to advance solar energy. The PLI scheme supports domestic manufacturing of high-efficiency solar photovoltaic modules.
- PAT targets energy-intensive industries, while the Energy Conservation Building Code and Eco Niwas Samhita address buildings. Efficient lighting also helps reduce energy demand.
- The National Green Hydrogen Mission targets 5 million metric tonnes annually by 2030, supported by approximately 125 GW renewable capacity and Rs 19,744 crore.
- Extended Producer Responsibility addresses plastics and electronic waste, including recycling. Mission LiFE promotes responsible mobility, while adaptation includes early warnings, resilient agriculture and water security.

KEY TAKEAWAY

India can pursue green growth through renewable energy, efficiency, cleaner industry, recycling and climate-resilient cities, supporting economic development while reducing environmental harm.